

Creative Inspire T7700 7.1 Speakers

Sound of inspiration

The Creative T7700 speakers are the first 7.1 speakers to be launched in the Indian market. The subwoofer is made completely of wood and



gives good depth to the bass. The wired remote has a new connector called M-port that allows you to connect compatible creative MP3 players.

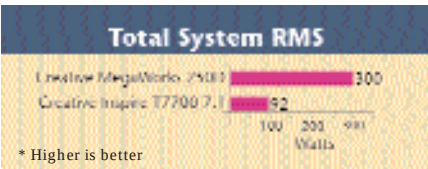
We tested the set with Creative's SoundBlaster Audigy 2 ZS Platinum PRO that offers 7.1 output.

The high and mid frequencies were excellent, but the subwoofer lacked the punch that one expects.

The speakers reproduced good sound in Serious Sam, a rather dullish sound in Quake 3, but excellent reproduction

with Halo, which has some amazing EAX effects. In the music tests, the sound was good, but at high volumes the tweeters go into overdrive.

Overall, this is a good product, as it can mix the sound output of a 5.1 sound card to give you decent 7.1 surround. So there's no immediate need to upgrade your sound card just yet—but you'll probably want to upgrade anyway, once you listen to these speakers on a 7.1 card.



SPECIFICATIONS

24W RMS subwoofer, 8W RMS satellites, 20W RMS centre satellite, dual-flared port tube in subwoofer, frequency response 40Hz~20KHz

Price: Rs 12,299
Contact: Creative Labs Asia
Phone: 98203-57713
E-mail: rajshekhar_bhatt@ctl.creative.com
Web site: http://asia.creative.com

Creative Inspire T7700 7.1 Speakers		A
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Build quality	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	

Emerge UPS 600

Emerge from darkness

The Emmerge UPS 600 claims to have a backup time of 20 minutes at full load, but this depends largely on the peripherals connected.

This unit has three power-out sockets—two with battery back up and one with only power surge protection.

The Emmerge

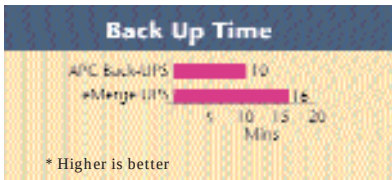


UPS comes with the WePLogic software, which runs in the background and helps shut down your system properly by saving your files. The package includes two power cords, a proprietary serial cord, an RJ11 cable, a manual and the software CD.

After charging the battery to the brim, we tested the

unit by attaching it to a Pentium 4, 3.06 GHz machine, an ATA100 hard drive and a 17-inch monitor. We booted the machine directly from the UPS and were able to keep the computer running for 16 minutes. However, the monitoring software didn't save any files, even after repeated attempts.

This UPS is a good buy for those who have regular power



outages, and need to save their work before shutting down.

SPECIFICATIONS

Line Interactive, operating range 160V-300V, 500VA/300 watts, overload protection, logical system shutdown

Price: Rs 3,775
Contact: WeP Peripherals Ltd
Phone: 080-227 0359
Fax: 080-227 0378
E-mail: chandrasekhar.k@wepindia.com
Web site: www.wepindia.com

Emmerge UPS 600		B
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Build quality	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	

EasyDisk 128 MB USB drive

Easy as pie

The EasyDisk 128 MB USB drive was one of the lightest we've got—only 11 grams. The drive has a silver body with a black cap. The cap is mostly plastic, which makes it a little flimsy.

We plugged the EasyDisk into our test machine, and Windows XP immediately detected it as a removable drive and also as a second floppy drive, which means it can be used as a bootable medium. The EasyDisk comes bundled with Windows 98 drivers, a desktop-locking program called PCLock, a mail utility that's compatible with Microsoft Outlook, a standard USB extension data cable, the user manual and a neck-strap.

In Sisoft Sandra, the device reported high random read and write speeds of 924 KBps and 680 KBps respectively.

Price: Rs 3500
Contact: GNH Systems
Phone: 022-2490 1333
E-mail: usbflashmemory@hotmail.com



tively. In HDTach, the random access time was reported at 6 milliseconds.

In our first test, we transferred a 20 MB TIFF image and a 20 MB folder to the drive. EasyDisk took only 9 seconds for the image, but 25 seconds for the assorted data. In our second test, we filled the drive to its entire capacity with both sequential and assorted files, and then calculated the actual transfer rates. The USB drive reported a speed of 0.71 MB per second for sequential data, and a transfer rate of 0.52 MB every second for the assorted folder.

The drive costs only Rs 3,500, and is quite a good buy considering its features.

SPECIFICATIONS

Size: 81x22x15 mm, Weight: 11 grams, 128 MB capacity, USB 1.1 interface

EasyDisk 128 MB USB drive		B+
Performance	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Features	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Build quality	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Value for money	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	